ReVive: Rethinking Vacant Spaces

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> **Revive spaces. Reconnect communities. Rethink urban living.**

ReVive is an "Airbnb for workspaces", and can be used for discovering and reusing underutilised spaces across Dortmund. It combines map-based space discovery, public-event discovery, AI-assisted search, listing details, reviews, and community submissions. Anyone can find and rent workspaces by the hour, day, week or year!

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Problem statement

Dortmund has many vacant shops, offices and rooms, but they stay empty because:

- **Empty spaces stay invisible.** There is no easy, current overview of what is free.
- **Demand and supply stay disconnected.** People who need a space cannot find owners, and owners cannot find people.
- **Platforms focus on long-term rentals.** Typical portals (ImmoScout24, WG-Gesucht and similar) are built for long leases or housing.
- **Short rentals are hard.** Many places are available, but it is not easy to rent one for just a few days.

The result: idle buildings, dark shop windows, and good ideas (a pop-up shop, a tutoring class, a workshop) that never start because a long lease is too big a risk.

Motivation

The idea came from a real search. While looking for a venue for the next DO-DATA hackathon, we saw many empty buildings, but none could be rented for just a few days. Vacant property is more than an empty building: it is a missed economic opportunity and a space that could contribute to the city's development.

Solution

ReVive is a single platform that brings spaces, people and events together:

- **Flexible duration:** rent a space for anything from 2 days to 2 years.
- **Shared slots:** one space can serve several tenants, e.g. person A Monday to Friday and person B on the weekend.
- **AI search:** describe what you need in plain words, for example *"A tutoring space for my students, under €200 a day"*. A language model turns the sentence into filters, and a rule-based engine searches the listings, so results always come from real records and never from model guesses.
- **Comprehensive listing details:** price, size, capacity, availability, amenities, parking, public transport, nearby places and reviews.
- **Events layer:** public events are shown on the map so you can rent a space near what is happening. Hosts can list their own events.
- **One app for all:** owners, tenants and event organisers use the same platform.

Our goal is to connect **available places with people who can bring them to life**.

Benefits and impact

For property owners

- Income from days and hours that would otherwise stay empty, without signing a long contract.
- Listing is free.

For tenants (startups, freelancers, small businesses, tutors, clubs)

- Test an idea for a weekend before committing to a lease.
- Find a matching space in seconds instead of searching through scattered sources.

For event organisers and communities

- Find affordable venues close to other local activity.

For the city

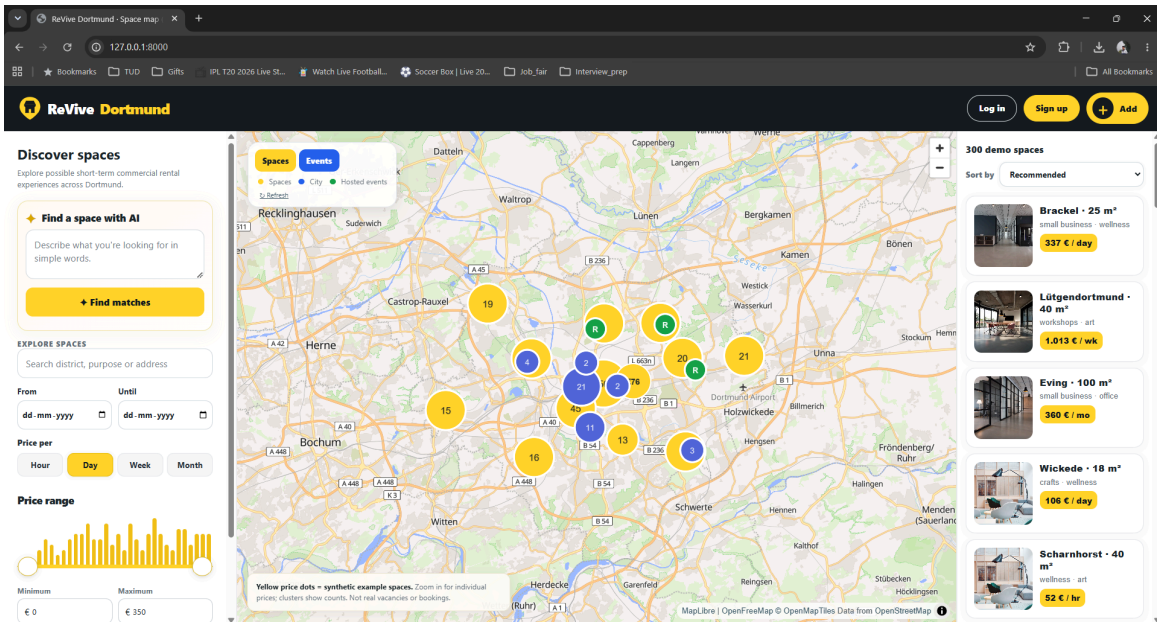
- Fewer dark windows: short bookings put people back into empty shops.
- Sustainability by design: it unlocks value from buildings that already exist instead of new construction.
- A boost for the local economy and for connected neighbourhoods.
- With real listings, a live picture of which streets have empty space and which kinds of space people want (useful input for the Wirtschaftsförderung).

Prototype features

- **Interactive map:** Browse spaces geographically.
- **Listing cards:** Scan location, size, purpose, and indicative pricing.
- **Search and filters:** Narrow results to fit user needs.
- **Sorting:** Sort by price, area, availability period, and minimum rental duration when data is available.
- **AI-assisted search:** Find relevant spaces using natural-language descriptions alongside conventional filters.
- **Space details:** View address, size, capacity, pricing, availability, facilities, permitted/suggested uses, photos where available, and reviews.
- **Reviews and ratings:** View feedback and submit a review where enabled.
- **Public events:** Discover event information and locations.
- **Add a listing / Add an event:** The **+ Add** action opens a form for submitting a space or event, with essential fields required and other fields optional.
- **FastAPI backend:** Provides data and supported search, review, and submission operations.

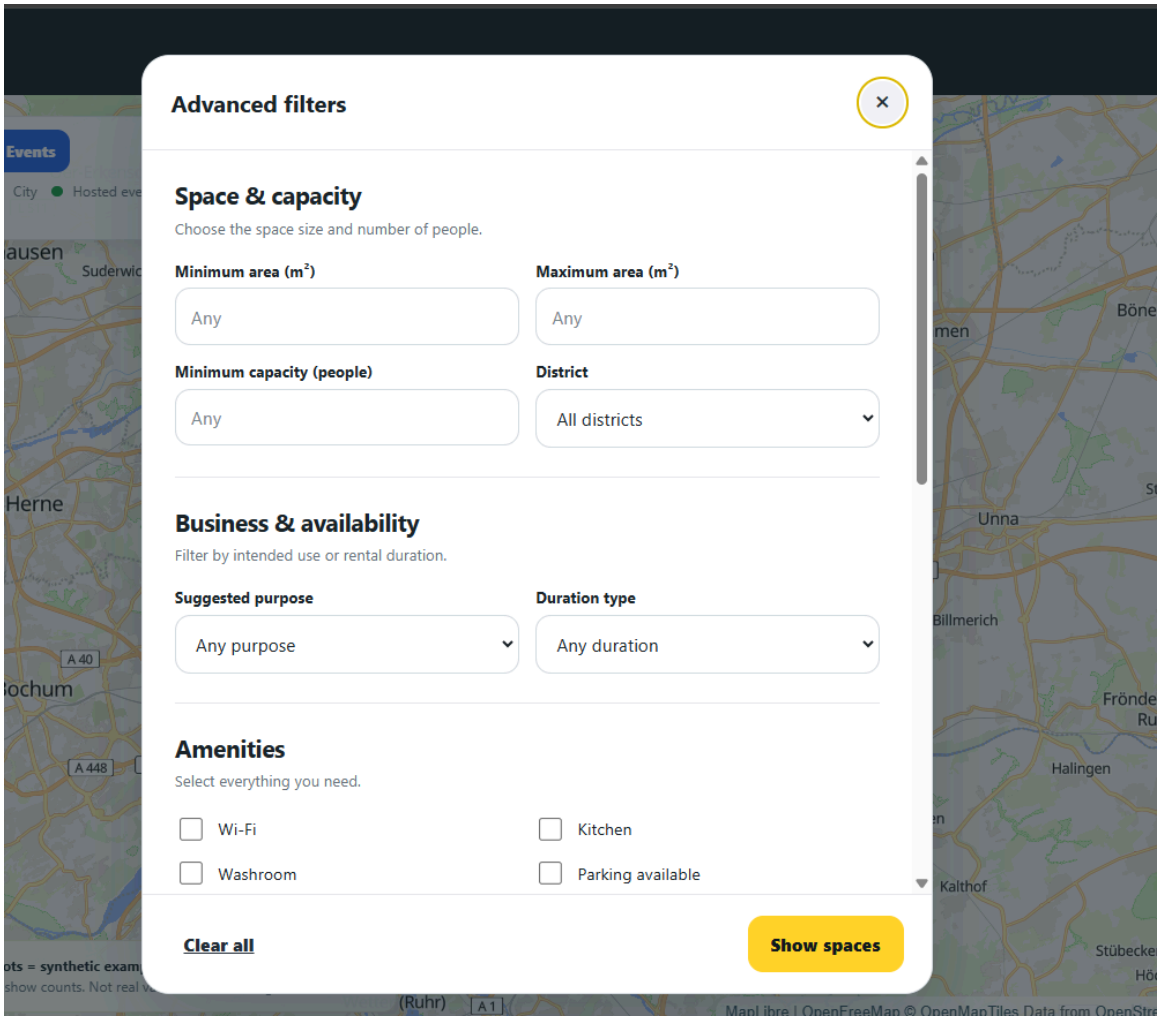
Website walkthrough

1. Map and discovery page



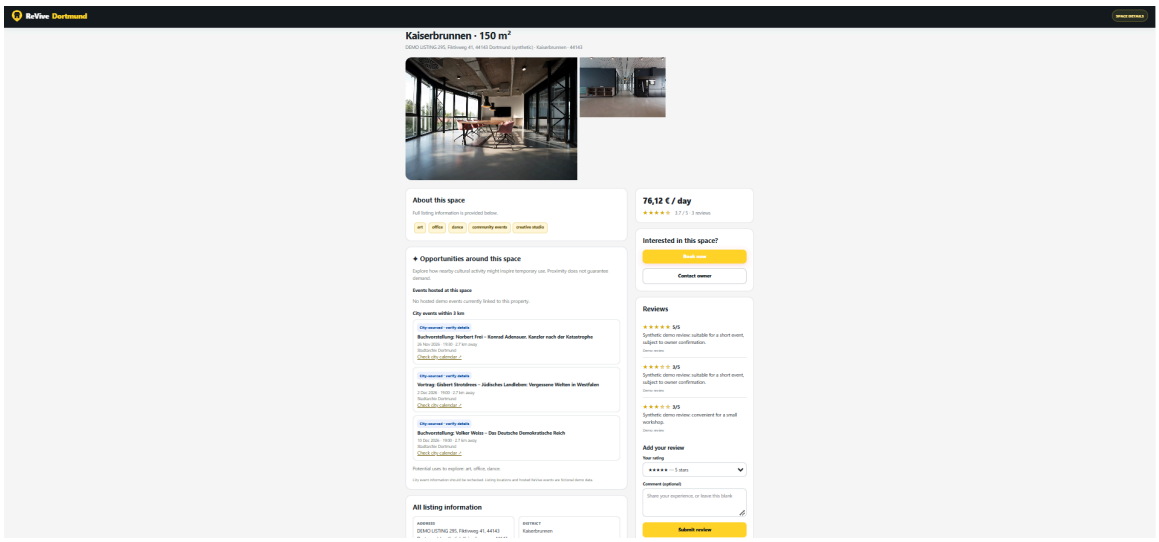
The map is the main entry point. Users browse space markers and cards, search, filter, sort, and explore opportunities around Dortmund.

2. Search, filters, and sorting



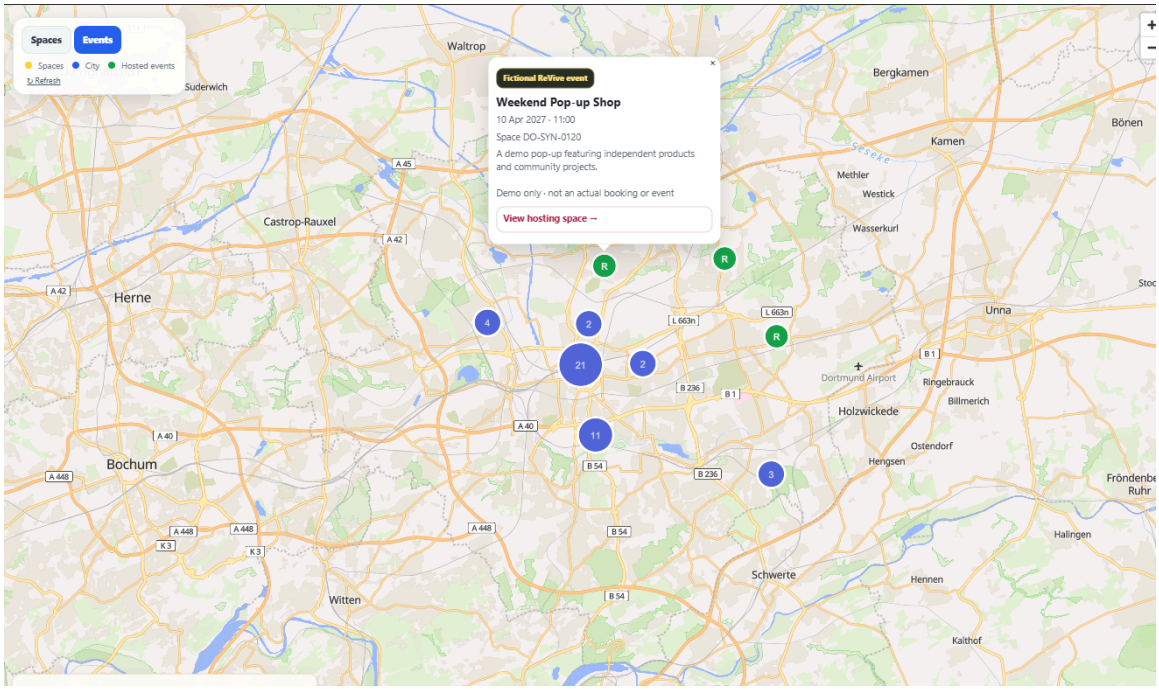
Users refine results and sort by price, area, availability period, and minimum rental duration. Availability-based sorting relies on relevant data being present.

3. Space detail page



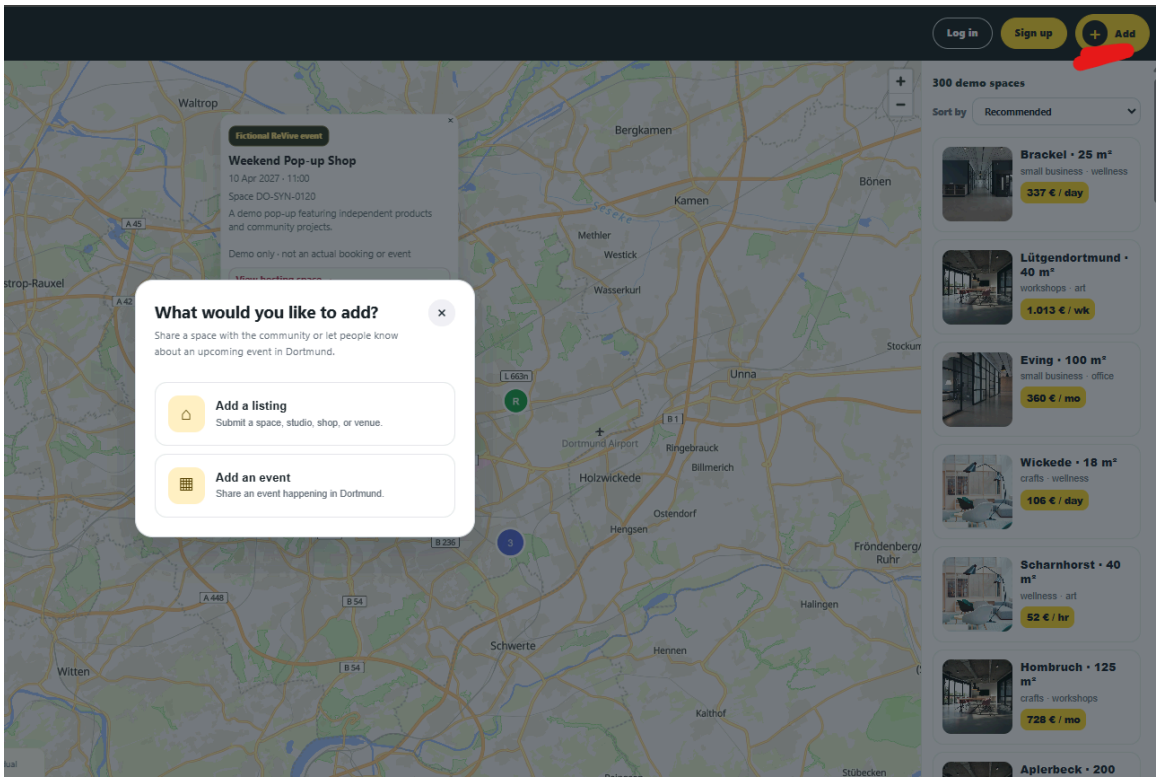
A listing page shows practical information such as address, area, capacity, pricing, available days, transport, nearby places, permitted purposes, facilities, photos, and reviews where available.

4. Public events



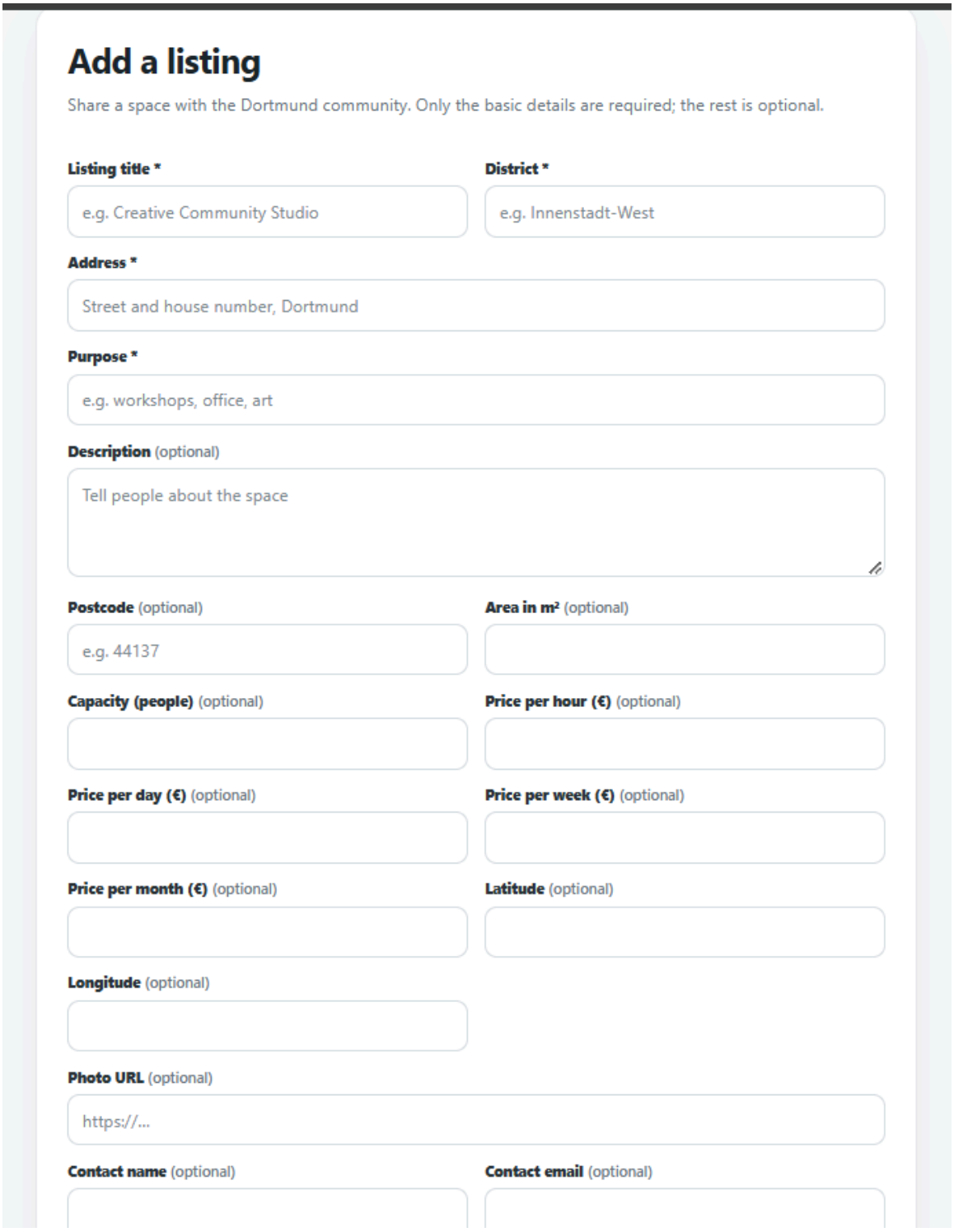
The event experience shows public events and location information, connecting local activities with places in the city.

5. Add a listing or event



The **+ Add** control lets users choose between adding a space and adding an event. Each option opens a form with essential fields required and additional fields optional.

6. Submission flow



Forms submit data to the backend. New records are marked pending review in the prototype; a production service should provide full moderation and verification.

Data and sources

The prototype uses a **mix of synthetic/demo data and real public-event information**.

APIs

The backend uses **FastAPI**. When running locally, interactive API documentation is available at `/docs`.

Endpoint	Purpose
`GET /`	Serves the web application entry point.
`POST /spaces`	Creates a space listing from submitted form data.
`POST /events`	Creates a public event from submitted form data.
Review endpoints	Support reviews and ratings; consult `/docs` for exact paths and schemas.
Search endpoints	Support space discovery and AI-assisted search; consult `/docs` for exact paths and parameters.

Target audience and business model

Target audiences: property owners and managers; startups and small businesses; event organisers, artists, and creators; NGOs and community groups; residents and visitors.

Potential future business model (not currently implemented):

1. Free basic listings and discovery.
2. Commission on confirmed bookings once a real booking workflow exists.
3. Optional premium listing visibility.

Future work

1. **Verified listings:** Owner verification, moderation, reporting, and expiry of outdated records.
2. **Expanding to different cities:** Expanding our product to cities more cities in Germany.
3. **Accounts and dashboards:** Saved listings, owner tools, and submission management.
4. **Automatic Contract Generation:** Generating contracts between landlors and tenants automatically on the website right after the space is booked.
5. **Impact measurement:** Evaluate utilisation, successful matches, community participation, and sustainability indicators.
6. **Production readiness:** Automated tests, logging, rate limiting, security reviews, and deployment monitoring.

Vision

A Dortmund where no space goes to waste, and every empty space holds the potential to bring a community to life.

We aim to move beyond listing vacant properties: the longer-term vision is a local ecosystem where underused spaces become easier to discover, use, and connect with meaningful activity.

> **Let’s stop seeing empty spaces—and start seeing endless possibilities. Let’s ReVive Dortmund!**

Links

- **Repository:** GitHub repository URL
- **Pitch deck:** Pitch deck URL.

Team

Name	Role	LinkedIn Profile
Avi Gupta	CEO	LinkedIn
Farah Somrani	COO	LinkedIn
Nixon M Paulson	CFO	LinkedIn
Türkan Yildizoglu	CTO	Github